

LUCIDPREP

Grade 9 English Language Arts Curriculum

U.S. Standards-Aligned Course Syllabus

ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS

English I

36 weeks • 4 modules • 70% mastery

Curriculum Architecture

This course is organized as 36 weeks across four 9-week modules. Every week follows LucidPrep's established secondary learning cycle: AI Instructor opening, objectives, vocabulary, five warm-ups, main lecture, two short tutorial videos, AI Instructor presentation, two homework sets, and a 40-question assessment.

Mastery standard: 70%+. Students below mastery review the instructional presentation and may retake the assessment, matching the existing LucidPrep secondary model.

U.S. Alignment Note

The U.S. does not have one national Grade 9 English sequence. In most districts Grade 9 English is English I. This curriculum uses the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts & Literacy (grades 9–10) as the primary national reference and cross-checks major themes against California Common Core and Texas English I TEKS. Course placement varies by district, so this is presented as a U.S. Standards-Aligned Grade 9 course.

Prepared for LucidPrep • Curriculum Planning Edition • 2026

Common Instructional & Assessment Model

Weekly Learning Cycle

Step	Component	Description
1	Opening / Domain Overview	~2-minute AI Instructor introduction
2	Objectives + Vocabulary	Student-facing outcomes and core terminology
3	Warm-Up	5 questions with explanations
4	Main Lecture	Concept instruction, models and examples
5	Video Tutorials	2 short instructional videos
6	AI Instructor Presentation	Visual models, examples, strategies and applications
7	Homework	Two sets of 5 questions
8	Weekly Assessment	40 questions; 70% mastery
9	Review / Retake	Below mastery → review presentation → retake

Assessment Philosophy

Questions should emphasize reasoning, explanation, modeling, interpretation of data or text, application to unfamiliar problems, and evidence-based thinking rather than recall alone. Each module assessment should sample all major concepts and include scenario, data/text and constructed-response items.

This 36-week course is designed around **CCSS ELA-Literacy 9-10: Reading Literature (RL), Reading Informational (RI), Writing (W), Speaking & Listening (SL), Language (L)**. It is a full-year curriculum with four nine-week modules and a consistent LucidPrep mastery workflow.

Grade	9
Course	English I
Duration	36 weeks
Structure	4 modules × 9 weeks
Weekly assessment	40 questions
Mastery threshold	70%
Module assessments	Weeks 9, 18, 27
Final assessment	Week 36

Course Learning Outcomes

- Read and analyze complex literary and informational texts, citing strong textual evidence.
- Write arguments, informative/explanatory texts and narratives with clear reasoning.
- Conduct research and integrate credible sources responsibly.
- Speak and listen effectively in collaborative and formal settings.
- Command grammar, usage and academic vocabulary to make effective language choices.

Module 1 — Close Reading & Narrative

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
Week 1 — Reading Closely & Citing Evidence	Annotation; explicit vs. inferred meaning; strong and thorough textual evidence	Cite strong evidence; draw and support inferences	RL.9-10.1; RI.9-10.1
Week 2 — Elements of Fiction & Plot	Plot structure; conflict; setting; narrative arc; pacing of events	Analyze how plot elements build meaning	RL.9-10.3/5
Week 3 — Character & Complex Motivation	Complex characters; development; interaction; conflicting motivations	Analyze how complex characters develop and advance theme	RL.9-10.3
Week 4 — Theme & Central Idea	Theme development over a text; supporting details; objective summary	Determine and trace a theme; summarize objectively	RL.9-10.2
Week 5 — Word Choice, Tone & Figurative Language	Diction; connotation; figurative and connotative meaning; tone and mood	Analyze how word choice shapes tone and meaning	RL.9-10.4; L.9-10.5
Week 6 — Point of View & Narrative Technique	Narrator and point of view; effect on meaning; cultural perspective	Analyze point of view and its effect on a text	RL.9-10.6
Week 7 — Narrative Writing	Real or imagined experience; dialogue, pacing, description; event sequencing	Write a well-structured, technique-rich narrative	W.9-10.3
Week 8 — Grammar & Sentence Craft	Parts of speech; phrases and clauses; sentence variety; revising for style	Apply conventions; vary sentences for effect	L.9-10.1/2/3
Week 9 — Module Assessment	Close-reading analysis and narrative writing	Synthesize skills; demonstrate 70%+ mastery	Performance assessment

Module delivery notes. Balance literary and informational texts within the grades 9-10 complexity band. Anchor every unit in close reading and text-based evidence, with regular writing across argument, informative and narrative modes and speaking and listening woven throughout.

Module 2 — Informational Text & Argument

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
Week 1 — Central Ideas in Informational Text	Central idea; development across a text; objective summary of nonfiction	Determine and trace central ideas	RI.9-10.2
Week 2 — Text Structure & Idea Development	Organizational patterns; how ideas/claims are developed and refined	Analyze text structure and idea development	RI.9-10.3/5
Week 3 — Author's Purpose, Point of View & Rhetoric	Purpose; point of view; rhetoric; appeals (ethos, pathos, logos)	Analyze how rhetoric advances an author's purpose	RI.9-10.6
Week 4 — Evaluating Arguments & Evidence	Claims; reasoning; relevance and sufficiency of evidence; logical fallacies	Delineate and evaluate an argument and its claims	RI.9-10.8
Week 5 — Seminal Texts & Multiple Accounts	Seminal U.S. documents; accounts of a subject across different mediums	Analyze seminal texts and multimodal accounts	RI.9-10.7/9
Week 6 — Building an Argument	Precise claim; counterclaim; reasoning; relevant evidence; organization	Plan a logically organized, evidence-based argument	W.9-10.1
Week 7 — Writing the Argument Essay	Drafting; transitions; formal style and tone; effective conclusion	Write a coherent argumentative essay	W.9-10.1/4
Week 8 — Revising, Vocabulary & Conventions	Revising for clarity and style; academic vocabulary; style-manual conventions	Revise and edit; use academic vocabulary accurately	W.9-10.5; L.9-10.4/6
Week 9 — Module Assessment	Informational analysis and argumentative writing	Synthesize skills; demonstrate 70%+ mastery	Performance assessment

Module delivery notes. Balance literary and informational texts within the grades 9–10 complexity band. Anchor every unit in close reading and text-based evidence, with regular writing across argument, informative and narrative modes and speaking and listening woven throughout.

Module 3 — Drama, Poetry & Literary Analysis

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
Week 1 — Introduction to Drama	Dramatic structure; dialogue; stage directions; dramatic devices	Analyze the elements of drama	RL.9-10.3/5
Week 2 — Shakespearean Drama	Verse and language; soliloquy; dramatic irony; historical context	Analyze Shakespeare's craft and language	RL.9-10.4/5
Week 3 — Theme & Character in Drama	Theme development; complex characters across a full play	Trace theme and character across a drama	RL.9-10.2/3
Week 4 — Source Material & Transformation	How authors draw on and transform source material (e.g., myth, history)	Analyze how a work transforms its source material	RL.9-10.9
Week 5 — Introduction to Poetry	Form and structure; line and stanza; rhyme, meter, sound devices	Analyze poetic form and sound	RL.9-10.4/5
Week 6 — Figurative Language & Imagery	Metaphor; symbol; imagery; extended and connotative meaning	Interpret figurative language in poetry	RL.9-10.4; L.9-10.5
Week 7 — Comparing Across Mediums	A subject or scene in two artistic mediums (text, film, art); emphasis and omission	Compare treatments of a subject across mediums	RL.9-10.7
Week 8 — Literary Analysis Essay	Thesis; textual evidence; analysis; literary present tense; organization	Write an evidence-based literary analysis	W.9-10.2/9
Week 9 — Module Assessment	Drama and poetry analysis and literary-analysis writing	Synthesize skills; demonstrate 70%+ mastery	Performance assessment

Module delivery notes. Balance literary and informational texts within the grades 9–10 complexity band. Anchor every unit in close reading and text-based evidence, with regular writing across argument, informative and narrative modes and speaking and listening woven throughout.

Module 4 — Research, Media & Synthesis

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
Week 1 — Research Questions & Planning	Developing a focused question; narrowing or broadening the inquiry	Formulate a research question and plan an inquiry	W.9-10.7
Week 2 — Finding & Evaluating Sources	Credibility; relevance; authority; search strategies	Gather and evaluate credible sources	W.9-10.8
Week 3 — Integrating Sources & Academic Honesty	Quoting, paraphrasing, summarizing; citation and MLA basics; avoiding plagiarism	Integrate sources and cite them responsibly	W.9-10.8; L.9-10.3
Week 4 — Synthesizing Information	Combining multiple sources; reconciling conflicting information	Synthesize evidence across several sources	W.9-10.7/9; RI.9-10.7
Week 5 — Writing the Research Paper	Thesis; structure; evidence integration; drafting	Draft a source-based research paper	W.9-10.2/7
Week 6 — Analyzing Media & Information	Media messages; bias; multimodal accounts; digital literacy	Analyze and evaluate media accounts of a subject	RI.9-10.7; SL.9-10.2
Week 7 — Speaking, Listening & Presentation	Collaborative discussion; evidence-based reasoning; presenting findings	Present findings; participate effectively in discussion	SL.9-10.1/4/5
Week 8 — Language, Style & Review	Knowledge of language; style-manual conventions; revision; cumulative vocabulary	Refine style and command of conventions	L.9-10.1/2/3/6
Week 9 — Final Assessment	Full-course synthesis: reading analysis, research and writing across modes	Demonstrate cumulative course mastery	Final performance assessment

Module delivery notes. Balance literary and informational texts within the grades 9–10 complexity band. Anchor every unit in close reading and text-based evidence, with regular writing across argument, informative and narrative modes and speaking and listening woven throughout.

Assessment & Alignment

Assessment Blueprint

Warm-ups: weekly • Homework: weekly • Weekly assessment: 40 questions • Module assessments: Weeks 9 / 18 / 27 • Final: Week 36 • Below 70%: instructional review and retake.

Standards Alignment

Primary framework	CCSS ELA-Literacy grades 9–10: RL, RI, W, SL, L (with CCR anchor standards)
Literacy Practices	Close reading; citing textual evidence; analysis; argumentation; research & inquiry; writing across modes; collaborative discussion; command of conventions
Recurring Concepts	Evidence; central idea & theme; structure; point of view & purpose; craft & tone; synthesis across texts and media
State mapping	California Common Core and Texas TEKS can be mapped at chapter / question level without changing the core 36-week structure.

Content Production Guidance

For each week, expand the syllabus topic into the established LucidPrep package: ~2-minute opening, objectives, vocabulary, 5 warm-ups with explanations, lecture, 2 ~2-minute videos, AI Instructor presentation, two homework sets of 5, 40-question assessment, answer explanations and mastery/retake handling. Build question banks around problems, scenarios, data, texts and application.

Curriculum Basis & Source Notes

This document is a U.S.-aligned curriculum architecture, not a claim of a single nationwide Grade 9 sequence. In most U.S. districts Grade 9 English is English I; course placement and titles vary by state and district.

Primary reference	Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts & Literacy — grades 9–10 Reading (Literature and Informational Text), Writing, Speaking & Listening and Language strands, with the CCR anchor standards.
State cross-check	California Department of Education — California Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts (grades 9–10).
State cross-check	Texas Education Agency — English I TEKS: foundational language skills; comprehension; response; multiple genres; author's purpose and craft; composition; and inquiry & research.
LucidPrep product alignment	36-week / four-module secondary architecture, weekly instructional components, 40-question assessments, 70% mastery, and review/retake pathway.

Recommended next production step. Add standards metadata to each chapter and question (RL/RI/W/SL/L codes plus state-framework identifiers) so LucidPrep can support multiple U.S. state alignments without duplicating the course.